

Option B2: The reigns of King Richard I and King John, 1189–1216

Key topic 1: Life and government in England, 1189–1216	
1 The feudal system	- The feudal hierarchy and the nature of feudalism (landholding, homage, knight service, labour service); forfeiture. - The role and influence of the Church.
2 Kingship and succession	- The nature of kingship: duties, rights, rituals. - Richard I as king: his claim to the throne; how power was secured; his character. - John as king: his claim to the throne; how power was secured and the murder of Prince Arthur; John's character.
3 Royal government and finances	- How England was governed when Richard was absent, 1189–99, and during King John's continued presence in England, 1199–1216. - Royal revenues: the royal demesne and the role of sheriffs in collecting revenues; feudal incidents; scutage; taxes on moveables and income in 1207.
4 English society	- Countryside: the nature of agriculture and peasant life. - Towns: life in towns; their role in the economy. - Jews in Medieval England: legal status; role in moneylending; antisemitism; the causes and extent of the pogroms of 1189–90, including the significance of the coronation of Richard I; royal exploitation via taxes.
Key topic 2: Involvements overseas, 1189–1204	
1 The nature of crusading	- The concept of crusade and attitudes in England to the crusades. - The nature of the English crusading army: who they were, why they went.
2 Richard and the Third Crusade	- The immediate causes of the Third Crusade; Richard's motives for involvement in the Third Crusade. - Richard's quarrel with Philip II; Richard's military victories at Acre and Arsuf. - The failure to recapture Jerusalem.
3 Aftermath of the crusade	- Richard's return from the Holy Land. - Richard's capture, the ransom and its burden on England.
4 Richard, John and the loss of Normandy	- The competing aims of Richard and John and Philip II in Normandy. - Richard and Chateau Gaillard: its cost and importance. - John and the fall of Chateau Gaillard; the loss of Normandy (1204).

Key topic 3: King John's downfall, 1205–16

1 The dispute with the Papacy	• Causes of the dispute. • The Interdict and its impact on everyday life. • The significance of the reconciliation between John and Innocent III.
2 Worsening relations with the barons	• Growing financial impositions to raise money for war with France: taxation and 'fines'; John's use of arbitrary power. The plot of 1212. • The impact of the failure to regain Normandy in 1214. • The rebellion of 1215: Northampton, Lincoln, the march on London.
3 Magna Carta and the First Barons' War	• Runnymede: the motives of John and the barons, and the main provisions of Magna Carta. • Reasons for the outbreak of the First Baron's War. The siege and taking of Rochester; the invasion of Prince Louis.
4 England in 1216	• The condition of England at the time of John's death. • The problem of the succession. • The role of William Marshal as Protector.